

Internal Regulation: Data Retention and Disposal Policy

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1. Policy Statement

All business records, whether physical or digital, must be retained only for the period required by applicable law or operational need, and securely disposed of thereafter to reduce legal and security risk.

2. Retention Periods by Record Type

Financial records (invoices, tax filings): 10 years. Employee records: 5 years after termination. Customer support tickets: 3 years. Internal audit reports: 7 years. Marketing materials: 2 years or until superseded.

3. Disposal Procedure

Physical documents past their retention period must be shredded using a cross-cut shredder rated P-4 or higher. Digital records must be deleted using a secure-erase utility and the deletion logged in the IT Asset Management system with a timestamp and the responsible employee's ID.

4. Exceptions

Records subject to an active legal hold must NOT be disposed of regardless of retention period expiry. Legal holds are issued by the Legal department and override this policy until formally lifted in writing.

5. Roles and Accountability

Department heads are accountable for ensuring records under their control follow this policy. The IT Security team audits compliance quarterly and reports findings to the Compliance Committee.

6. Violations

Failure to comply with this policy, including premature disposal of records under legal hold, is treated as a serious compliance violation and may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.